member Thein Sein. The months following the transition saw some of the most significant progress in the history of modern Myanmar. Thein Sein has moved rapidly to begin implementing an ambitious reform agenda first set in his March 2011 inaugural address. Longtime critics of the regime are being consulted and what seems like a sincere attempt at reconciliation is being pushed.

Eventually an approach of cooperation and coordination was implemented between the authorities and Aung San Suu Kyi. This process led to the first in a series of meeting between Suu Kyi and Thein Sein on August 19, 2011. The meeting was held in the new capital of Naypyidaw. This was Aung San Suu Kyi's first visit to the capital. Furthermore, Suu Kyi was invited to attend meetings on the future of the Myanmar economy. The almost unbelievable meetings, subsequent photo opportunities, and state dinner invitations between Thein Sein and the several leading generals and Aung San Suu Kyi stunned international observers. The public nature of the meeting was a radical departure from how earlier negotiations had progressed. Nearly all talks and discussions over the past two decades had taken place in secrecy. Later meetings in 2011 between Aung San Suu Kyi and the Myanmar authorities confirmed that the relationship was vastly different under this new administration. She seems convinced that the new administration is sincere in efforts to move Myanmar forward.

The initial reforms put forward by the regime included legalizing trade unions, the establishment of a human rights commission, and the release of political prisoners, and changes to electoral law. This final change allowed the NLD to once again participate in the political process. The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is ready to embrace the new regime and will offer Myanmar leadership of the organization for 2014. This decision will be stipulated on the regime continuing on the road to progress on the political front. Economic and political reform will be accelerated, especially as the international community gets on-board to promote progress. The main goals of the president's reform agenda include reinvigorating the economy, reforming national politics, and improving human rights.

The major obstacles to the progress may be resistance from hardliners within the regime and some of the established military bureaucracy, which see reform as a danger to their power base. The inherent weakness of any